a template that was adopted by the Afghan Taliban and also demonstrated by the Lal Masjid clerics.

Above all, with the increase in militancy, 'the militant labour demand may evolve toward greater reliance on madrasahs for recruits' (Fair, 2009).

The madrasahs and religious parties, which have been good factors for the spread of religious education and teachings of Islam, were misused by some with ulterior motives. They dabbled in sectarianism and the so-called jihad, which earned them an unfavourable image nationally and internationally. Religious extremism, sectarianism and militancy owed much to the Jihadi organisations, and a number of madrasahs involved in it. Unchecked propensity to issue fatawa was set a tone for the Islamist militancy as the militants derived legitimacy of their actions from these religious edicts.

Afghanistan

Historically, Afghanistan had never been a state in the real sense. Despite the presence of a federal government in Kabul, the administration in most areas had been influenced or governed by ethnicities, militias and warlords. There had been a slack central control, whereas anarchy and banditry remained rampant. King Zahir Shah ruled for 40 years, but his writ and reforms were mostly confined to Kabul only. He was deposed in 1973 in a bloodless coup by his brother-in-law Sardar Muhammad Daud Khan who declared himself the President of Afghanistan. Later, he was killed in a coup by the army factions in 1978. After him, the successive Soviet backed governments of Nur Muhammad Taraki, Hafeezullah Amin, Babrak Karmal and finally Najibullah further weakened the writ of state, and the existing schisms widened. In December 1979, the Soviet forces entered Afghanistan and another bloody era ensued as the US and Pakistan backed Mujahideen fought a prolonged war against the Soviet forces. This process did not remain confined to Afghanistan only. Pakistan's tribal areas, FATA and also the NWFP (now KP) got infested with the Afghan militants, Al Qaeda and their local supporters. Pakistan faced severe violence, Kalashnikov culture, heroine and hosted more than 3 million Afghan refugees from Afghanistan. The 2,500-km-long porous Pak-Afghan border is a source of unhindered border crossing by all sorts of elements from both sides. Al Qaeda and Afghan Taliban crossed this border in 2001 after the US attack on Afghanistan and